



ETHICS

GE006



THE ETHICAL DIMENSION OF HUMAN EXISTENCE



OBJECTIVES

- Identify the ethical aspect of human life and the scope of ethical thinking
- Define and explain the terms that are relevant to ethical thinking
- Evaluate difficulties that are involved in maintaining certain commonly-held notion of ethics.



- August , 2007
- Criz Anthony Mendez, 21, student of UP passed away due to physical injuries as a result of hazing under Sigma Rho fraternity.
- None came forward to assume responsibility for the death of Cris.
- This tragic death case was remained unresolved.



QUESTIONS:

- **What is the value of one's life?**
- **What were the wrongs done to Crisby his so-called fraternity brothers?**
- **Is there any good to fraternities?**



ETHICS

- about matters such as the good thing that we should pursue and the bad thing that we should avoid.
- the right ways in which we could or should act and the wrong ways of acting.
- about what is acceptable and unacceptable in human behavior.
- obligations that we are expected to fulfill, prohibitions that we are required to respect, or ideals that we are encouraged to meet.
- matters that concern life and death such as war, capital punishment or abortion and concerns human beings such as poverty, inequality or sexual identity.



**DO ALL INSTANCES OF MAKING
VALUE JUDGMENTS CAN BE
CONSIDERED AS ETHICS?**



AESTHETICS

- Derived from the Greek word aesthesis (“sense” or “feeling”)
- Refers to the judgment of personal approval or disapproval that we make about what we see, hear, smell or taste.
- Personal preferences
- Examples are: Preferences in terms of movies, food, and dress



ETIQUETTE

- concerned with right or wrong actions but those which might be considered as not quite grave enough to belong to a discussion of ethics.
- Examples: Using the word “please” while asking for something; offering a seat to an elderly.



TECHNICAL

- derived from the Greek word “techne” and English words “technique” and “technical” which are used to refer to a proper way of doing things.
- Examples are, learning how to bake; learning how to play basketball.



ETHICS AND MORALS

- **MORALS** -may be used to refer to specific beliefs or attitudes that people have or to describe acts that perform.
 - individual's personal conduct.
- **ETHICS** -A discipline of studying and understanding ideal human behavior and ideal ways of thinking.
 - Acknowledged as an intellectual discipline belong to philosophy.



DESCRIPTIVE AND NORMATIVE

- **Descriptive**

- study of ethics reports how people, particularly groups, make their moral valuations without making any judgment either for or against these valuations.
- Examples are work of the social scientist (historian or anthropologist)

- **Normative**

- study of ethics done in philosophy engages in the question: What could or should be considered as the right way of acting?
- Prescribes what we ought to maintain as our standards or bases for moral valuation.



- A philosophical discussion goes beyond recognizing the characteristics of some descriptive theory.
- It does not simply accept as correct any normative theory.
- A philosophical discussion of ethics engaged in a critical consideration of strengths and weaknesses of these normative theories.



MORAL ISSUE

- a situation that calls for moral valuation. when one is placed in a situation and confronted by the choice of what act to perform.
- situation wherein an individual cannot afford to buy a certain item and the possibility for
- him to steal is present in that situation.



MORAL DECISION

- An individual make when he/she is placed in a situation of moral issue.
- Action about a certain moral issue



MORAL JUDGMENT

- When a person is observer who makes an assessment on the actions or behavior of someone.
- assessment to the act of stealing as wrong



MORAL DILEMMA

- Going beyond the matter of choosing right over wrong, or good over bad
- Considering instead the more complicated situation where in one is torn between choosing one of two goods or choosing between the lesser of two evils
- A mother wanting to feed his hungry child but then recognizing it would be wrong to steal